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Teen And Up Audiences

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by FriendshipSnakes

Summary

Adora meets a cute driver for the Etherian ride share app.

Notes

Okay, here is my attempt at the SPOP creative flex. This is inspired by VHS Dreams - Nightdrive. Great song, check it out. I did not intentionally start this out as a current pandemic story, but that's what it turned into lol. So here you go. Also, as much as I try, Catra always has a black Prius in all my modern stories. haha.

Hit me up on twitter @omoshiroimidori **@omoshiroimidori** and tumblr **@FriendshipSnakes**

Adora looked at her phone, only three more minutes until her Etherian driver would be there. She was more than ready to get home and sleep for the next few days. It would be one of those 'order everything and ask the delivery person just to leave it on the doorstep' sort of weeks. In all honesty, that was primarily due to the pandemic Etheria had been working through for the last year and a half, but you know, she could try to pretend that things were okay. She loved the travel part of her job, but some of the national conferences she had to attend were draining, especially with the current state of the world. *Thank god for vaccines.* She pulled up the app again and checked to see the license plate number and the car's make. *Black Prius. At least it'll be spacious.*

A few moments later, a shiny black Prius pulled up in front of her; if she weren't looking for the car, she wouldn't have heard it. *They really are quiet.* She looked at the car for the Etherian driver stickers, walked around to the back to check the license plate, and opened the back door. "Who are you here to pick up?"

A person with a smooth voice and a basic black mask turned their head and said, "Adora."

"Okay, thank you." Adora got in the back seat and adjusted her mask to make sure it was fully covering her mouth and nose. She looked around the car and noticed how clean it was, not that she had really had any bad experiences, other than the once, but she could tell that this owner really cared for the car.

"Would you like to listen to music?" the driver asked while looking in the rearview mirror.

"Oh, no, thank you. I just got off a turbulent flight."

"Okay, I'm Catra, by the way."

"Nice to meet you; I'm Adora. Thank you for the ride. You have a really nice car."

"Oh, thank you. I try to keep it clean. This is the best car I've ever owned. If I'm lucky, I can drive it for another one hundred and fifty thousand miles."

"Wow, what's the mileage at now?"

Catra took a second to stop at a stop sign and she pressed a button on her steering wheel. "It looks like a little over two hundred thousand."

Adora was thrown back by how nice the car was with such high miles. "Wow, Priuses really do last a lifetime."

Catra laughed. "It's true; I'm glad I bought it." She looked at Adora in the rearview mirror. "So, what was your conference about?"

"Oh, confidentiality issues in victim services."

"Wow. That sounds intense."

Adora adjusted herself to lean on the door a bit as she talked with the woman driving. It was late and dark outside; she was tempted to fall asleep but knew it would not be wise to sleep in a stranger's car. "Yeah, I was a presenter on supporting victims, so I was one of a small group of people in person."

"That must be difficult and rewarding work."

"It really is. I've been doing it for so long that sometimes I forget the difference I make." She took out her bottle of water. "Is it okay if I drink a bit of my water?"

"Yes, thank you for asking *and* wearing a mask."

"Of course. I bet some people are not as easy to work with. Would it be okay if I rolled the window down a bit for a second too?"

"Yep. Good idea."

Adora took a breath, held it, pulled her mask down quickly, drank several gulps, put her mask back on, and finally breathed out. "Thank you." She rolled the window back up.

Catra smiled, "Yeah, there are folks who get mean and want to fight about it. I wish folks could just wear the masks, finish the five-minute ride, and be done with it."

"I'm sorry that happens to you. You put your life at risk every day to earn a living. Is this your only gig?"

"Yeah, I like it well enough. I get to meet interesting people." She looked at Adora through the rearview mirror again. "Like you. I didn't know there was a conference solely dedicated to confidentiality in victim services." Catra liked the blue eyes staring back at her. The bottom half of her face being covered by the mask was equal parts frustrating and exciting. *What did she look like?*

"Thank you. It's been nice talking with you. " Adora yawned. "Is this your last ride, or do you work late?

"No, you are my last. I'm gonna go home and watch some TV before I crash. I'm currently binging an awesome series. Have you seen Legend Of Korra? "

"Can I be honest with you? "

"Of course. "

"I'm obsessed." Adora started to unbutton her dress shirt. "I'm literally wearing a Korrasami shirt under my work clothes." She opened her shirt to show the woman.

"Wait, let me turn on a light to see you better." Catra pushed a few buttons above her, and a few lights powered on.

Adora pushed her chest out, trying to help Catra see. "I love them so much."

Catra adjusted herself to see the shift in the reflection of the mirror. "Wow! That is such a cute shirt. Would you mind if I get a better look when I drop you off?"

Adora noticed the heterochromatic eyes looking at her in the mirror. *Wow.* "It's such a cute shirt. You need to see it!"

Catra laughed. "I have seen the series a few times, but I just keep coming back to it. It has really helped me come out of my shell."

"Really? I feel the same way. I even embraced my sexuality fully after watching it." Adora felt her cheeks warm. Maybe that was a

bit of an overshare. She was getting a bit too comfortable with her driver; it was probably due to how exhausted she was."

"Hey, Adora? That sounds like a really positive experience. Thank you for sharing that with me." She knew how much the series had meant to her, and she could probably guess it meant something similar to Adora. This drive was much more pleasant than she anticipated for a late-night airport pick-up.

Adora smiled. "Thanks. I really love that show, and Asami is so cute."

"I cannot choose between the two! They are just so cute. I mean, Korra's muscles, though."

"You can say that again." Adora felt a sense of freedom and empowerment in talking about her identity and life so freely. And to think that she thought this ride would be drab and the longest thirty minutes of her life.

Catra slowed down gently and pulled off to the side of the road. "Okay, here is your stop."

Adora looked out of the window and saw her apartment complex. "Oh, that was fast. I feel like we barely had time to get to know each other." She opened the door and slowly walked out. When she reached back in, she asked, "Did you still want to look at my

shirt?" Then, taking hold of her luggage, she pulled it out as gracefully as she could.

"Oh, yeah. Thank you for reminding me." Catra pushed the park button and got out of the car. She walked around and stood in front of Adora, who nervously opened her shirt to show Catra. As much as she tried not to make the interaction creepy, it was starting to feel that way. They were standing in a dimly lit parking lot, and one woman was opening her shirt for the other.

"This kind of feels dirty." Adora laughed.

“It's a really cute shirt. Thank you for showing me. I'll have to look into getting more shirts."

"Drive home safe, Catra. It was really nice meeting you."

"Sleep well, Adora."

When Catra walked away, Adora immediately gave her a five-star rating and commented on how excellent the ride was. She took a quick breath and smiled— *time for three flights of stairs.*

*

As soon as Catra got home, she got ready for a shower. She would need it after the long day she had. A few rude riders, but she had met a cute, well the half of her face that she saw, woman and had a great conversation. Maybe single life was getting to her more than she cared to admit, but the possibility of seeing Adora again excited her.

After she was done with her shower, she popped some tater tots and chicken nuggets into her air fryer and finished getting ready for bed. *Nothing like a little Korra and some tots in bed to relax.* Her hair was short enough that all she had to do was rub a towel on it, and it was ready to go. So, she was ready to relax in no time. Once she had gotten dressed and taken her vitamins, she made a quick batch of fry sauce and went to lay down. She made it through most of her food before she passed out.

When she awoke the following day, the plate was sitting on the other half of her bed, and the fry sauce had spilled into the comforter. "Damnit." She rubbed her eyes but didn't immediately get up. She was going to work the early hours to give herself time to catch up on some house cleaning and grocery shopping later. You know, boring adult stuff. The fry sauce spill was the last bit of laundry that made it impossible to continue to ignore the enormous pile of dirty clothes in her bathroom. *Ugh.* Yet another thing she had to add to her list to do after work.

Her first rider was a grouchy older woman who turned out also to be a backseat driver. *Great* . The way the woman would say Catra's name was like an angry step-parent who was jealous of their new spouse's attention to their own child. It was unnerving. Once the woman was dropped off, Catra sighed and turned up her music. "God, that was the longest three minutes of my life."

The rest of the day went by slowly, with unhappy rider after unhappy rider. At this rate, she would need to start charging extra for the therapy she provided each person as they sat in her car. Finally, after a thirty-minute lull, Catra decided to call it a day and head to the store; groceries didn't buy themselves. Her monthly shopping trips were something she loved and hated. She was able to get fresh food and plan her meals, but there were still many people who were not adhering to the safety precautions, refusing to wear masks, and it terrified her. Her job already made her nervous, but it was what she had available, and she needed to pay rent. She was one of the lucky ones to get the vaccine when it became available to her. She opened her app to check her earnings for the day and got a pick-up request. *Adora.*

It had been a fantastic couple of days off, laying in bed, watching TV, eating take out, but now it was time for Adora to go back to work. Her car was at her office, and she would need to call an Etherian driver. As she scrolled through her phone to find the app, she really hoped that Catra was working. She had enjoyed talking with her a few days prior and wouldn't mind seeing her again. With the app pulled up, she typed in her information and hit request. She bit her finger, watching the screen, waiting for it to populate the request.

Mermista is three minutes away.

"Damn," she mumbled. *Better luck next time.*

She went through her safety ritual, checking the license plate and asking the driver who they were picking up. Once she got in the car, the woman driving said a brief, "Hey." It was a quiet ride that lasted only ten minutes. Mermista wasn't much of a talker, which Adora was fine with. She had other things on her mind than trying to make small talk. However, it would have been a lie to say that she wasn't in a *dry spell.* It had been almost a year since she last dated, and she thought that maybe it was time to see who's out there. Well, to see if Catra was out there. *Maybe she's on an app? Or maybe she's partnered?* Adora sank into her seat. With her luck, Catra would be happily married with two point five kids, six cats, and a house in the suburbs. She sighed.

"Here's your stop; totally have a good day."

"You too." She quickly grabbed her bag, waved, and shut the door —t *ime for work.*

*

Her workday had gone by a lot faster than she had anticipated. Typically, after a few days off, she would struggle to answer even the simplest emails. But, today, she felt increased energy and drive. Maybe the time off had been precisely what she needed after all that traveling. Before she stood up to gather her things, she turned off her computer and shut off all the lights in her office. Tonight would be a nice night to make pasta, lounge on the couch, and watch some TV.

She waved to all her coworkers and made her way down to the parking garage. When she walked out onto the level she always parked on; she reached into her pocket to grab her keys. When she got to her car, she looked down and immediately noticed that she didn't have her car keys on her key ring. *Damnit!* She had forgotten to reattach the car keys to her clip after she returned from her trip. They were probably still sitting on the table next to the door.

Standing next to her car for a moment, she thought about what she could do. *Maybe I can see if Scorpia can give me a ride home.* She pulled up her messages and started typing out a text to Scorpia. *Wait, maybe Catra is working?* She could just cancel the request if it wasn't her and finish texting Scorpia. With a shrug, she opened the Etherian app and requested a ride. Within a few seconds, a message popped up on the screen.

Catra is eight minutes away.

"Yes!" Adora jumped a little at the notification on her screen.

A voice behind her quickly chimed in, "Heck Adora, what are we celebrating?" Scorpia stood in the stairwell, looking at Adora.

"Oh, yeah. I just forgot my keys but was able to get a ride home. So, I'm happy."

"That's great to hear! If you ever need a ride, don't hesitate to ask! We are like neighbors." Scorpio smiled.

"Thanks, Scorpia." She waved as she walked to the street to wait for Catra. The butterflies in her stomach were becoming more active as each minute passed. *Is this weird? Am I weird? Should I be this excited to see an Etherian driver?* She folded her arms as she was starting to feel embarrassed at her excitement of seeing the woman again. This was the first time she had been thankful to have let a coworker drive her to the airport. Usually, the hassle of leaving cars in places to try and make it more convenient was a nightmare, but with the chance to see Catra again, she wouldn't even care if her car was impounded.

A few minutes later, a black Prius pulled up. Adora checked the license plate and opened the back door. "Hey, Catra!" Her excitement almost made her forget to get into the car. She stumbled for a moment and finally settled down on the clean seat.

"I was about to sign off, but when I saw you pop up on my app, I knew I had to take the request. How are you doing?"

"I'm doing great now. I really enjoyed our chat the other day and was hoping to see you again. But then, I forgot my keys today, so that worked out." She adjusted her mask and relaxed into the seat.

"I'm glad I made such an impression. Oh, and thank you for the rating last time; I got a little bonus because it was my twentieth

five-star rating in a row! So, I guess technically, you bought my Korrasami shirts that will arrive next week."

"Really? I am so happy to hear that! You more than deserve it." Adora beamed.

Catra laughed. "Thank you. I'm really excited actually to get the shirts."

"I can't wait to see them. Do you usually work every day?"

"Yeah, I usually work for eight to ten hours a day. There are more airport rides later in the day, so that's usually when I like to work. Those make the most money, and then I take a bunch of requests around that area and head home after a call that brings me back to my area."

"Wow, it sounds like you have it all planned out." Adora wished that she needed to go back to the airport. That would have been a nice long drive.

"Yeah, I learned pretty quickly what made the most money and what was not worth my time." Catra shrugged.

"So, you like Legend of Korra; what other hobbies do you have?"

"Good question; I really like to hike and take long drives with no destination in mind. I like to explore, really."

Adora had never really done things in the spur of the moment. She was a planner and made sure things were all set up before she ever set foot outside her apartment. "Oh, so you like to get in your car and just start driving until you land somewhere interesting?"

Catra looked at her in the mirror. "Yeah, I usually have a direction or general area I want to explore. I recently drove up the canyon to a place I had wanted to visit for years. It was really cool."

"That sounds wonderful. I may need to try that. Any suggestions on where I should try first?"

"Oh, good question. Sometimes I like to drive through unfamiliar neighborhoods and try to find my way out or try driving up the canyon just to see what's up there. You'll see some turn-offs and forks that can be explored later."

"That sounds fun. I think I'm going to try it."

Catra turned around. "Well, that was fast. Here is your stop."

Adora didn't want to leave; it wasn't enough time to talk to Catra. Although, she did need to get her car, and there was no better

time than the present. "Could you drive me back to my car? How do I request that?"

"Oh, it's easy, just click on the "add stop" button, and you can add it really quickly."

"Thanks, are you sure you can do it? I don't want to put you out."

"Yes, Adora. I'd love to."

She loved the sound of her name on Catra's lips, that was for sure. "Okay, I'm gonna go grab my keys. I'll be right back." Adora ran out of the car and up her stairs, forgetting her bag in Catra's car. She unlocked her door and grabbed her keys. Before she ran out of the house, she stopped to take a sip of water and grab a few granola bars. *Maybe Catra would want one.* Then, slamming the door behind her, she made her way downstairs.

She sat in the car and went to adjust her mask; she didn't have one on. "Oh my god. I forgot my mask. I'm so sorry. I'll be right back!"

"No, wait, I have an extra. Don't worry about it. Is black okay?" Catra opened her glove box and pulled out a mask still in the plastic wrap. She looked back at the gorgeous blonde woman sitting in her back seat. The rush of anxiety about being in a car with an unmasked person was drowned out by her inability to look

away. Adora's blue eyes were even more beautiful when she smiled. *Wow.*

"Thank you; I'm sorry I forgot. I'm vaccinated if it helps." Adora quickly put the mask on and grabbed one of the granola bars she had grabbed from her apartment. "I brought you a snack. I hope that's okay." Oh boy, did she feel terrible for forgetting her mask. *Good move, Adora.*

"Thank you; I love these! And I'm vaccinated too." Catra smiled.

"Oh, that's good to hear. I feel terrible. I'll make it up to you."

"You don't have to do that. I mean, it was a treat to see you without a mask." The words came out before she could stop herself. *Nothing like harassing your customer to make the day go by. Stupid!*

Too bad for the mask, because Adora's cheeks were warming. "Oh, thank you. That's kind of you to say." Adora adjusted her mask. "You have really pretty eyes, and I bet under your mask, there is an equally beautiful woman too." *Well, okay, it looks like I'm a flirt all of a sudden. Is this one of the symptoms? Should I get tested?* She looked around nervously.

Catra laughed softly, "Maybe one day you'll find out." She winked in the rearview mirror. "Okay, here is your stop. It was nice seeing you again."

"Thank you, Catra. I hope you have a good rest of your day." Adora got out of the car and grabbed her bag. She poked her head in to wave.

Catra grabbed her mask, pulled it down, and smiled. "I'll see you later."

Adora's red cheeks moved to her forehead and ears; there was no way that Catra couldn't tell she was blushing. *She's so pretty.* She stood there just staring at Catra for several moments.

"You doing okay there, Adora?" She smiled before she put her mask back on and adjusted it.

She laughed and scratched her head. "Yeah, you're very pretty, Catra."

Now it was Catra's turn to be flustered. "Oh, I- Thank you."

"Bye." Adora waved and shut the door. She felt a sort of elation at her admission. Did she just openly flirt with the gorgeous Etherian driver? You bet. And she couldn't wait to do it again.

It had been three days since she last saw Catra. She was trying not to be a creep and find her on social media. Adora knew how uncomfortable that would have made her. And there was no need to normalize stalking behavior. She had downloaded the First Ones dating app the day before, just to see what's out there. Well, that's what she told herself.

She hadn't taken the time to set up her profile, even though it would take all of ten minutes to do. It was the worst part of dating apps. She didn't like being on the apps, to begin with, and trying to think of something creative and fun to pique someone's interest was overwhelming. *Ugh.* But, she wasn't doing anything else, and she had already deep cleaned her apartment, so why not try to enjoy herself.

The promised ten minutes of profile set up had passed thirty minutes ago. It took Adora twenty minutes just to find pictures of her that weren't blurry, work-related or had a bunch of people in them. After she narrowed down her pictures, she started to type out her profile. It wasn't anything to write home about, but detailed enough to give a basic description of her and vague enough to make her seem interesting. Or so she hoped.

After the account was finished, she started swiping. It took all of fifteen minutes to go through the entire bunch of people available to her. No Catra. She sighed and set her phone down. *This is creepy. If Catra were into you, she would have said something.* Adora stood up and grabbed her gym bag.

Catra did not want to work. She had been out every day that week, and she just wanted to stay in bed watching TV. But, it had been slow for the past few days, and she needed to make up for the lack of riders. Sometimes she would drive for Brightmoon Eats, but they didn't pay as well, and her area was oversaturated with drivers. So, she generally didn't get many requests.

Putting on her cleanest pair of jeans, she brushed her teeth and ran a comb through her wild hair. Even the soft fur on her ears was out of sorts. *Today is going to be a long day.* Catra opened the app and signed in; it usually took a few minutes for the app to give her her first request. Then, before leaving the house, she grabbed the granola bar that Adora had given her a few days prior.

The day turned out to be great. Several folks were going to and from the airport. It seemed that as soon as she dropped someone off, another person a few feet away requested a ride. She had taken so many people that she had to stop and get gas between. Maybe she would treat herself tonight and pick up some nice take-out on her way home.

She parked her car at a gas station and ran in to get a soda while she waited for another request. Usually, she had a book or two in the car to help pass the time between rides, but today she decided just to scroll social media. She accidentally clicked one of the ads when she was trying to scroll up, and before she exited out, she recognized the app. The First Ones. It was the same one that Scorpia had met Perfuma on. *It wouldn't hurt to try. Adora may be on there.* She sat back in her car, sipping her drink, and quickly made a profile with a few random pics of her and a short tag line. "I do things; I like things; let's talk."

As soon as the app verified her profile, she started swiping. Woman after woman, some she recognized, some she didn't. She wasn't much of a dater, but driving people around for a living helped her meet half of the town. *Oh, I didn't know she was gay.* Finally, after a few more swipes, she saw Adora's profile. *Yes!* It was simple and, quite frankly, adorable.

Catra flipped through the pictures, and her heart rate rapidly increased. *Was this weird? Should I be doing this? Will she feel weird about this?* She swiped right. Not an instant match, which made sense since she had signed up for it a few minutes ago. If Adora did like her, she would know soon enough. Or maybe, Adora wasn't into her and just lonely from quarantine, looking to chat with anyone willing to have a conversation. She sighed.

She looked out the window watching a couple argue about what grade of gas to get. They were young, and one partner looked very pregnant. A toddler was pounding on the window in the back seat; it was apparent that the child had figured out how to unlock the seatbelt. As she became more invested in the scene playing out in the parking lot, her phone dinged with a new request. She unlocked it and saw the name on the screen. *Adora.*

Adora was standing in the parking lot of her apartment complex, waiting for Catra. She wasn't wearing a mask until she saw Catra pull up and quickly put it on and waved. Catra had to admit; she loved Adora's little wave. Of course, it really wasn't needed after she had said goodbye, but dang, was it cute.

"Hey, Adora."

"Hey, Catra."

"It looks like you are hungry today. Did your car crap out on you?" Catra turned to look at her.

"Oh no, I just didn't want to drive, honestly. I'm glad you were working."

"Me too. It's been a week since I've seen you last. My shirts came!"

"Oh, I can't wait to see! Which ones did you get?" Adora leaned forward, somehow expecting to be able to see Catra's shirt.

"I got a few with fan art and then, of course, the last scene. I honestly cry every time I see it; I can't even hear the music. It's just so beautiful."

"Oh, love that scene! It's been at least a year since I've seen it; I need to rewatch it!"

Catra turned into the parking lot of a local favorite, *Mara's Tacos,* which honestly had the best Mexican food in the area. "Okay, do you want me to go through the drive-through or park outside and wait?"

"Are you hungry?"

The question entirely caught Catra off guard. "I- uh...well…"

"It's okay if you are not comfortable. I can just run in-"

"Oh, no. It's okay. I just...are you sure?" But, of course, it wasn't every day that a gorgeous blonde requested you to drive her to one of your favorite restaurants and bought you dinner.

"I would love to buy you dinner. Would you like to come in and order?"

"Yeah, that sounds great." Catra turned off the car and waited for Adora to meet her on the sidewalk before locking it. "If you want, we could eat across the street at that park. They have a cool pond with some neat fish."

"That sounds great." Adora opened the door and followed Catra in.

They both stood next to each other, looking at the menu.

Adora turned to Catra as she adjusted her mask. "What do you normally get?"

"I really like the tacos, but I usually get a burrito." Catra's tail swung excitedly behind her.

"A burrito does sound good. Or nachos. If I got a side of fries, would you share them with me?"

"Yeah, that also sounds really good. Maybe I was more hungry than I thought." Catra didn't bother eating before she left her apartment, and the smells coming from the grill made her stomach rumble.

The two women ordered and took their food across the street to sit at one of the concrete tables at the park. Catra pulled out some hand sanitizer, used it, and slid it over to Adora. They sat diagonally at the table, making sure to be at least six feet away. The light breeze helped put Catra's nerves at ease. Adora was busy dividing the fries into both halves of the takeaway box for extra safety.

Catra watched as Adora took her mask off and placed it in her pocket. Those pretty blue eyes still matched the rest of her face. She slipped her mask off and shoved it in her pocket before rubbing the back of her ears. Unfortunately, those masks were not made for ears as big as hers.

Adora looked up at Catra to ask her how her food was and caught Catra looking at her. They both blushed. "Do the straps hurt your ears?"

"Yeah, it rubs on the backs of them and takes off some of the hair." She rubbed her ears again.

"I'm sorry. That sounds painful. I could rub them if you'd like." Adora caught herself immediately after she finished her sentence. "I mean, if that...was something...you…I-"

"Adora, it's okay. And I would really like that." Catra smiled and put a few fries in her mouth. "Oh, these are so good."

"Aren't they? They are probably my favorite fries in the city too. So crispy on the outside and fluffy on the inside."

"This burrito is so good. How is it possible for a place to make everything perfect?" Catra basically melted into her seat, moaning.

"I always get the nachos but never finish. Do you want to try them? I got chicken." Adora pushed her box closer to Catra.

"Only if you don't make fun of me." She laughed. "Chips are as hard as tacos to eat." Catra opened her mouth and touched the point of a fang with her tongue.

"Oh! I didn't even think about that." Adora looked away, a bit embarrassed.

"Hey, it's okay. I have pretty normal issues, but they just happen to be with my ears, fangs, and tail." She laughed softly. "They really are minor problems to have."

Adora smiled. "Your tail looks soft. Do you have to do anything special to keep it that nice?"

She grabbed her tail and ran her hand over it. "Yeah, I use a special conditioner after I shower and try to keep it dry. Do you want to feel it?"

"Could I? I mean, I can wait until I rub your ears after we finish eating." Adora poured the rest of the green sauce on her nachos.

After the women ate and talked for a while longer, Adora put on her mask and threw their garbage away. "Can I come sit by you?" She grabbed the hand sanitizer from the table.

"Yes." Catra was getting a bit nervous. The cute blonde she had met a few weeks ago was going to touch her ears and tail. She tried to hide her excitement, but her tail always gave her away. Okay, maybe it had been a really long quarantine, and she missed even the most platonic of touches from another human.

Adora handed the hand sanitizer to Catra. "Okay. Do you want me to sit behind you or by your side?"

"Behind me is fine."

They adjusted and took their places. Catra held her mask over her face while letting the straps fall loose so that Adora could work on the sore spots.

"Where can I touch your tail? I imagine the closer to the base is more sensitive." Adora placed her hands on her thighs, waiting for Catra's direction.

"Oh, thank you for asking. Sometimes I forget people don't know where to pet." She held up the tip and showed Adora the first six inches or so. She didn't want this to turn into something more than it should be.

Adora took Catra's tail from her and gently held it while running her free hand over the incredibly soft fur. Whatever conditioner Catra used, Adora needed to buy it. "It's so soft. Wow."

Catra laughed. "I'm glad you like it." A purr was threatening to be released. It took every last bit of self-control to keep it at bay. Catra smoothing her tail fur was nothing compared to Adora

touching it. There was something so comforting about Adora, like she wouldn't let anything bad happen while they were together.

After a few more strokes, Adora gently set the tail down, and Catra didn't move it from Adora's lap. "Is it okay to touch your ears? How do you like your ears rubbed?" She was a bit nervous to touch Catra's ears, she didn't want to hurt her further, but she was also curious about what they felt like.

Her cheeks warmed at the questions Adora asked. When she woke up this morning, she had no idea that this was how her day would end. "I guess just softly. I'll let you know if it's too much."

Adora moved her hands to Catra's head. "Okay, I'll start with one and move to the other." Her hands made contact with the soft-furred ears, and she slowly moved her fingers in circles. It was apparent that Catra melted under her. Her ears were incredibly soft and a lot warmer than Adora imagined. But, with how much work her ears did, it made sense they were well circulated. "How does that feel?"

"So good." The purr that Catra was trying to keep down was more potent than any bit of self-control she thought she had. She hoped that Adora couldn't hear it but was sure that she could. Adora's hands were so delicate and gentle; she avoided direct pressure on the sore spots and thoroughly massaged the thin skin.

"I really like how soft the fur on your tail and ears is. Can I ask what you use to make it this soft?" Adora could smell the soft,

pleasant scent lingering between her and Catra's heads.

Catra smiled, "I actually use a really cheap leave-in conditioner that I put on after I wash it, and I make sure only to wash it once a week - if that."

Adora paused, "Wait, really?"

"Yeah, it's really quite simple."

"I bet that's nice." Adora finished the second ear and placed her hands back in her lap. "I hope that was relaxing and helped with any pain you were having."

Catra put her mask fully on and repositioned herself to face Adora. "Thank you; they already feel better."

They sat looking into each other's eyes for several moments. It was a warm, early summer day, and everything was perfect. Catra wanted to reach out to Adora and feel her skin, hold her hand. But, she still had no idea if Adora was into her or if she would feel comfortable with touching. So, instead, she just enjoyed the moment.

Adora's phone buzzed, and she looked down. "Oh my god, Catra, we have been here for almost two hours. I'm so sorry I took so much of your time. You were working." She immediately got up

and started to collect her things. "If I request a ride, will it automatically choose you since you are so close?" Her app was loading slowly, and she had a look of worry on her face.

"Hey, Adora?" Catra said calmly.

Adora was too busy panicking and trying to get the app to load. "The app froze; I'm gonna restart my phone."

Catra walked toward the upset woman and placed her hand over Adora's. "Let me drive you home, Adora."

Adora looked up and stiffened. "Okay." They stood there for a few moments, enjoying the contact. If the tail petting and ear massaging weren't enough, the soft hands holding hers were almost overwhelming. "A-are you sure?"

"Yes, Adora. I'm sure. Thank you for dinner." Catra led Adora by the hand back to her car. Adora followed speechlessly and had a big dumb smile the entire time. Once Catra opened the car, Adora slipped in and gave her the address.

"I remember where you live, I've taken you home like six times, remember?"

Adora felt her cheeks warm. It really had been that many times; it was obvious that her attempts to see Catra were noticed. "I guess

that's true."

Once they pulled up to Adora's apartment, Catra turned to look at Adora in the back seat. "Next time, dinner is on me. Have a good night, Adora."

She looked at Catra, not wanting to leave. It had been such a wonderful couple of hours, and she didn't want it to end. "Catra? Could I hug you?"

Catra's eyes went wide. She was not expecting Adora to ask that or anything at all. But, even if she wanted to say no to Adora, there was no way she could; those bright blue eyes staring back at her were exhilarating. "Yes." She quickly parked the car and opened her car door to meet Adora on the other side. But, before she could even stand up, Adora was waiting there for her.

Adora stood there looking as bashful as ever; even though she was the one that asked for the hug, she was now too nervous about making a move to initiate the connection. It's not like she had never hugged someone before, and both of them were vaccinated and masked. But, the nervousness was still there. Then, just as her mind started to race, she felt the warm sensation of Catra's arms around her waist.

Catra couldn't wait any longer for the tall blonde to hug her; in the few short weeks that she had gotten to know Adora, she knew that Adora was a bit of a nervous person. She was sure that the pandemic had contributed to that, but she mostly thought it was endearing. The feeling of Adora's warm body on her felt incredible. She wanted to rub her face against Adora but thought

it would be too much to start marking her. They were but mere acquaintances.

"You smell good."

"I must have a potent scent if you can smell it through your mask." Catra mused.

"I like it." Adora hugged Catra tighter before letting go. "I hope you have a good night, Catra. Thank you for having dinner with me."

Catra was a little saddened by the separation. Adora felt so perfect in her arms. When she laid her head on Adora's chest, she could hear her quick heartbeat, which slowed down as their hug went on. "Thanks for inviting me. Sleep well."

Adora waved and walked toward her building. She looked back briefly to watch Catra drive away. Her heart sank. *Catra.*

After a few busy days at work, Adora was more than ready to relax for the weekend. She decided that a nice relaxing bath and a big pasta dinner would be just the thing to help her relax. Looking through her pantry, she located a few jars of sauce and a selection of different kinds of pasta. She really liked angel hair, but

damn if the fun-shaped ones weren't just as good. The question she needed to ask herself was really what utensil she wanted to eat with, a spoon or a fork. After looking at each box closely, she decided that it was a fork night. She put everything else away and got out a few pans to start dinner.

After she filled one pot with water, she set it on the stove and went to run her bath. After that, she would bathe and start the water before putting lotion on and getting dressed. That way, she would be all ready for bed after she had a full belly. With as much pasta as she had, she wished that she had Catra's number to invite her over, even if it was just as friends.

Adora walked to the bathroom and settled in the water. She played some soft music on her phone and relaxed in the hot water. The size of the tub was one of the draws of the apartment. It was one of the only complexes that understood the benefit of a nice tub.

The music on her phone stopped playing, and she went to pick it up. As she scrolled through the apps to restart it, she saw The First Ones dating app. *It wouldn't hurt to check.* She pulled up the app, and the first face that popped up on her screen was Catra. Adora immediately sat up in the tub and almost dropped her phone. She set her phone down to try and steady herself. *She's on the app.*

Within a few moments, she calmed down enough to look at the app again. She clicked on Catra's profile and looked through her pictures. *She's so cute.* Visions of her massaging Catra's tail and ears filled her mind. *Would she like me back?* For a moment, she

thought about just closing the app and not risk the rejection, but a bigger part of her trusted that Catra felt the same.

She swiped right.

There was an instant animation saying that there was a match. Adora's heartbeat increased rapidly. *A match. We matched!* She sat there in shock, looking down at her phone long enough that her screen dimmed. The app gave her an option to message Catra immediately or look at her profile again. She clicked on the message box. *What do I even write?* She sat in the now lukewarm water, thinking about what the first message should be. Before she could think of anything, a notification popped up. Catra had messaged her.

Catra: *Hey, Adora.*

Adora's heart fluttered. *This is really happening.* She started to type a reply.

Adora: *Hey, Catra. How are you?*

Almost instantly, Catra messaged back.

Catra: *I'm very good now. I was kicking myself for not asking for your number the other day.*

Adora: *Really? Because I have wanted to talk to you too.*

Catra: *:)*

Catra: *What are you doing right now? I was about to go for a night drive up the canyon. Would you like to come?*

Adora: *That sounds great! Are you hungry? I was just about to make pasta. You could come over and eat before we go for a drive.*

Catra: *That sounds perfect. I'll be over in ten minutes. Is that okay?*

Adora: *Yes! I'll start the water. I'll even do the driving, so you can relax and be driven somewhere. :)*

Catra: *Haha. You're so cute, Adora.*

After Adora set her phone down, she threw her hands into the air. "Yes!" Catra liked her *and* was coming over for dinner. What a grand night this would be. Her first exploration drive would be *with* Catra. She quickly got out of the tub and grabbed a towel, and started to dry off. Unfortunately, when she looked in the mirror, she still had soap in her hair. *Crap!* She jumped back in,

washed the shampoo out, and quickly tossed in some conditioner. After waiting maybe thirty seconds, she washed it out too.

She threw the towel around her and walked as fast as she could to the kitchen, and turned on the stove. Quickly looking around, her apartment looked somewhat presentable, but if she got dressed quick enough, she could tidy up the central area. As she ran to her room, she towel-dried her wet hair and threw the damp towel in the bathroom. Next, she threw on some comfortable clothes that were nice enough to be seen in public but comfortable enough to lounge in. It was eight in the evening; she hoped Catra would be okay with it since it was a spur-of-the-moment thing.

Adora quickly went through the front room, collected all the dirty dishes, dirty clothes, and fixed the cushions. She grabbed a blanket from her bed and tossed it over the back of the couch to make it look like she usually had a blanket on her couch as if that was some sort of indication of class. She went to the kitchen, put the pasta in the boiling water, and tossed the sauce jars in another pot. She had forgotten to preheat the oven, so she would have to use her air-fryer for the garlic bread.

She looked around after and sat at her table waiting for Catra. It took her a minute to realize that Catra didn't know her apartment number. She went to grab her phone and message her.

Adora: *I forgot to tell you the apartment number. Lol. A4.*

But after she sent the message, she thought it would be better to meet Catra down where they usually met for pick-ups and drop-offs. So she slipped on her flip-flops and walked down to the street. Her heart was beating faster than she thought possible. She kept checking her phone to see if Catra had messaged her back.

A few minutes passed, and Adora was starting to worry. *Maybe she didn't mean tonight.* She folded her arms, thinking about what to do, and then she heard her name.

"Sorry, I forgot that I would have to find parking this time." Catra laughed.

Adora smiled. "I'm glad you made it safe." She took a moment to take in the cute woman walking toward her. Catra had on some comfortable-looking joggers and a t-shirt. It looks like they both had the same thing in mind.

Catra slipped on her mask and followed Adora up the stairs. "I guess we didn't talk about masks specifically. How do you feel about us not wearing them since we are both vaccinated?"

"Oh, you're right. I don't know how I could have forgotten that. But, I have been fully vaccinated for a few months. So, I'm okay with it if you are."

"Okay, me too." Catra took off her mask and slipped it into her pocket.

When Adora opened her door, she immediately said, "I hope it's not too dirty!"

Catra laughed, "I'm sure it's fine. I'm too hungry even to notice."

"Oh, I'm glad to hear that. It should be ready in a minute. I'm just gonna toss in some garlic bread, and then we should be good. Do you want anything to drink? I have a few sodas and like water."

"Do you have milk? I absolutely love milk with pasta."

"I do. That actually sounds kind of good." Adora poured them both a glass of milk before she plated their food. She made sure to put out the red pepper flakes and an assortment of cheeses to top their dishes.

Catra took the first bite. "Oh, this is so good."

"Thanks." Adora's cheeks warmed. "It is just bottled sauce, but I add a few spices and, of course, butter."

"Well played."

Adora smiled as she watched the woman she had been thinking about for weeks sitting in her house eating dinner with her. "Where are we driving to?"

"Oh, yeah. I thought we could drive up to the reservoir. It's really pretty in the moonlight. I texted my best friend where we were going and shared my location, just in case. You should tell someone too."

"Oh, that is a good idea. I'll text Scorpia right now."

"Wait, you know Scorpia?"

"Yeah, we work together. She's the HR person at my job."

"She is who I texted. When I said I was going over to your house, she kept asking about you and where you worked. I thought it was kind of nice for her to care that much, but now I know why." Catra pulled out her phone and texted Scorpia. "Do you mind if we take a picture and send it to her?"

"Let's do it!" Adora stood next to Catra and smiled for the camera. They looked at the picture before Catra sent it. *They even looked cute together.* Then, no more than thirty seconds later, Adora's phone went off. "Oh gosh. Scorpia is calling." She laughed and answered. "Hey, Scorpia."

"I didn't know you liked Catra! I would have set you two up! Gosh, you two really are perfect for each other."

Adora scratched the back of her head as Catra heard every word, being that the phone was on speaker. "Scorpia, we are gonna finish eating. I'll send you my location in a minute too."

"Have fun and be safe; you too, wildcat."

Adora hung up. "I cannot wait to hear the origins of that nickname."

Catra blushed as Adora looked at her fondly.

It didn't take long for them to finish dinner. Adora started putting everything away as Catra set their dishes in the sink. "Do you want to take any of this home? I think I got a bit too excited when you were gonna come over."

"Yeah, that sounds great. I'll grab it when we get back." Catra leaned on the counter, watching Adora separate the pasta and sauce into a few containers. She even did that cute.

Adora grabbed a few snacks and sodas to add to a bag along with a flashlight. "Should we bring anything else?"

Catra looked in the bag. "This looks perfect. I'll fill up my water bottle before we go too."

After they had packed into Adora's car, she turned to Catra. "Can I hold your hand?"

Catra looked at Adora, took her free hand, and smiled.

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